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4.2 Flower

In a plant, which part would you like the most? Of course, it is a flower, because of its colour and fragrance. The flower is a significant diagnostic feature of angiosperms. It is a modified condensed reproductive shoot. The growth of the flower shoot is determinate.

4.2.1 Whorls of flower

There are two whorls, accessory and essential. Accessory whorl consists of calyx and corolla and essential whorl comprises of androecium and gynoecium.

Flower is said to be **Complete** when it contains all four whorls. An **Incomplete** flower is devoid of one or more whorls.

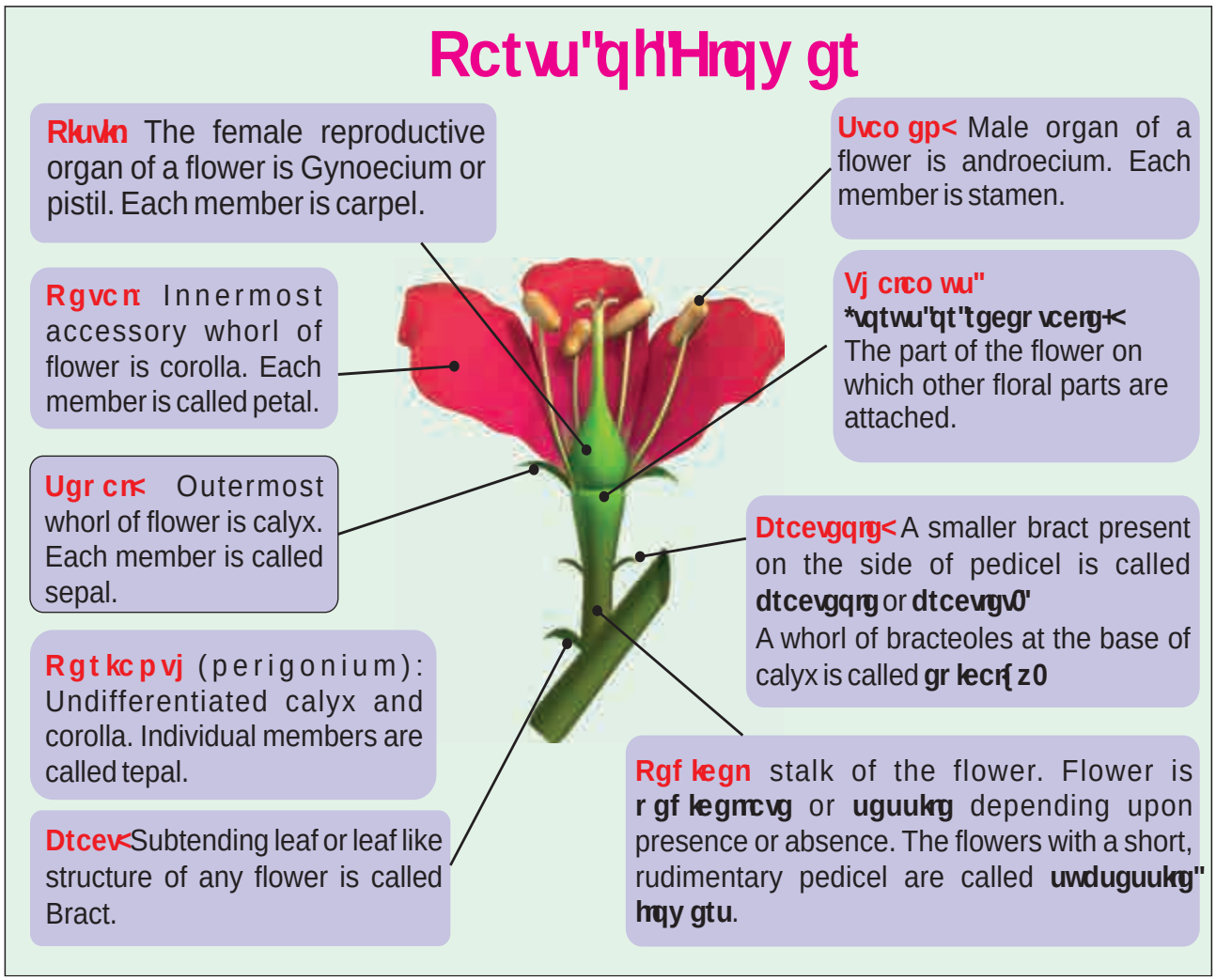

Figure 4.10: Parts of flower

4.2.2 Flower sex

Flower sex refers to the presence or absence of androecium and gynoecium within a flower.

1. Perfect or bisexual(monoclinous): When a flower contains both androecium and gynoecium is called **perfect flower**.

2. Imperfect or unisexual (diclinous): When the flower contains only one of the essential whorls is called **Imperfect flower**. It is of two types:

i) **Staminate flowers**: Flowers only with androecium alone are called **staminate flowers**.